33. **Subantarctic rainforests**
Temperate rainforests-similar to those found in British Columbia, Canada, and in the northwestern United States-grow in southern Chile at low and moderate elevations, thanks to abundant rainfall. The most typical trees belong to the genus *Nothofagus* (beech trees found in the cooler parts of the Southern Hemisphere), the northern species of which are evergreen and the southern species deciduous. Various conifers, notably the alerce and araucarias, mingle with the leafy trees. A dense undergrowth of shrubs, lianas, bamboos, ferns, mosses, and epiphytes grow in the northern districts but disappear toward latitude 49° S. In southern Chilean Patagonia, forests consist of twisted, creeping trees merging into a kind of heath.
34. The equator passes through three countries in South America. They are Ecuador, Colombia and Brazil.
35. Bolivia and Paraguay are the only countries which are landlocked in South America.
36. With the impending advent of the widespread use of electric cars, trucks plus the millions of rechargeable consumer electronic devices that utilise lithium ion batteries, it is no wonder that numerous exploration companies have turned their attention to the vast Lithium Triangle in Argentina, Chile and Bolivia. It has been estimated that South America's Lithium Triangle hosts about 54% of the world's lithium resources.